

Party Planning Checklist

Four weeks out to party day — every task in the order it actually needs to happen.

Event: _____ Date: _____ Guests: _____

4+ Weeks Before

- ☐ Set the date and the budget
- ☐ Book the venue (or pick the backyard)
- ☐ Draft the guest list
- ☐ Choose a theme
- ☐ Book key vendors — baker, photographer

2-3 Weeks Before

- ☐ Send the invitations
- ☐ Plan the menu
- ☐ Order decorations and supplies
- ☐ Plan activities and music
- ☐ Arrange rentals — tables, chairs, linens

1 Week Before

- ☐ Confirm RSVPs and final headcount
- ☐ Buy non-perishable food and drinks
- ☐ Confirm vendors and helpers
- ☐ Build the playlist
- ☐ Sketch the room layout

The Day Before

- ☐ Buy fresh food and ice
- ☐ Prep every make-ahead dish
- ☐ Charge the camera and speakers
- ☐ Put up decorations
- ☐ Confirm pickup and delivery times

Party Day

- ☐ Final setup and lighting
- ☐ Put drinks on ice an hour early
- ☐ Set out the food stations
- ☐ Take photos before guests arrive
- ☐ Relax — you're hosting, not working

Birthday Party Planner

The whole party on one page — who, what, where, and what to buy.

Party for:	Age turning:
Date:	Time:
Location:	Theme:
Colors:	Guests expected:

Guest list

Food & cake plan

Activities & entertainment

Supplies to Buy

- ☐ Invitations
- ☐ Balloons and decorations
- ☐ Plates, cups, and cutlery
- ☐ Cake and candles
- ☐ Party favors
- ☐ Drinks and ice
- ☐ Tablecloths and napkins
- ☐ Thank-you cards

Potluck Signup Sheet

Pass it around early — no more five potato salads and no main dish.

Event: _____ Date: _____ Host: _____

Name	Dish they're bringing	Type	Serves	Allergens?

Please ask guests to label any dish containing nuts, dairy, eggs, or gluten.

Host provides _____

Gift Tracker

Ideas, budgets, and what's already bought and wrapped — for birthdays, holidays, and every occasion between.

Season / occasion: _____ Total budget: \$ _____

Occasion	Date	Person	Gift	Budget	Bought	Wrapped
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐
					☐	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Under / over budget: \$ _____

Gift ideas for next time

Thank-You Card List

Every gift gets a card. Check them off as they go in the mail.

Event: _____ Event date: _____

Received from	Gift	Date received	Card sent	Date sent
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	

Aim to send within two weeks of the event — a late card still beats no card.

Notes